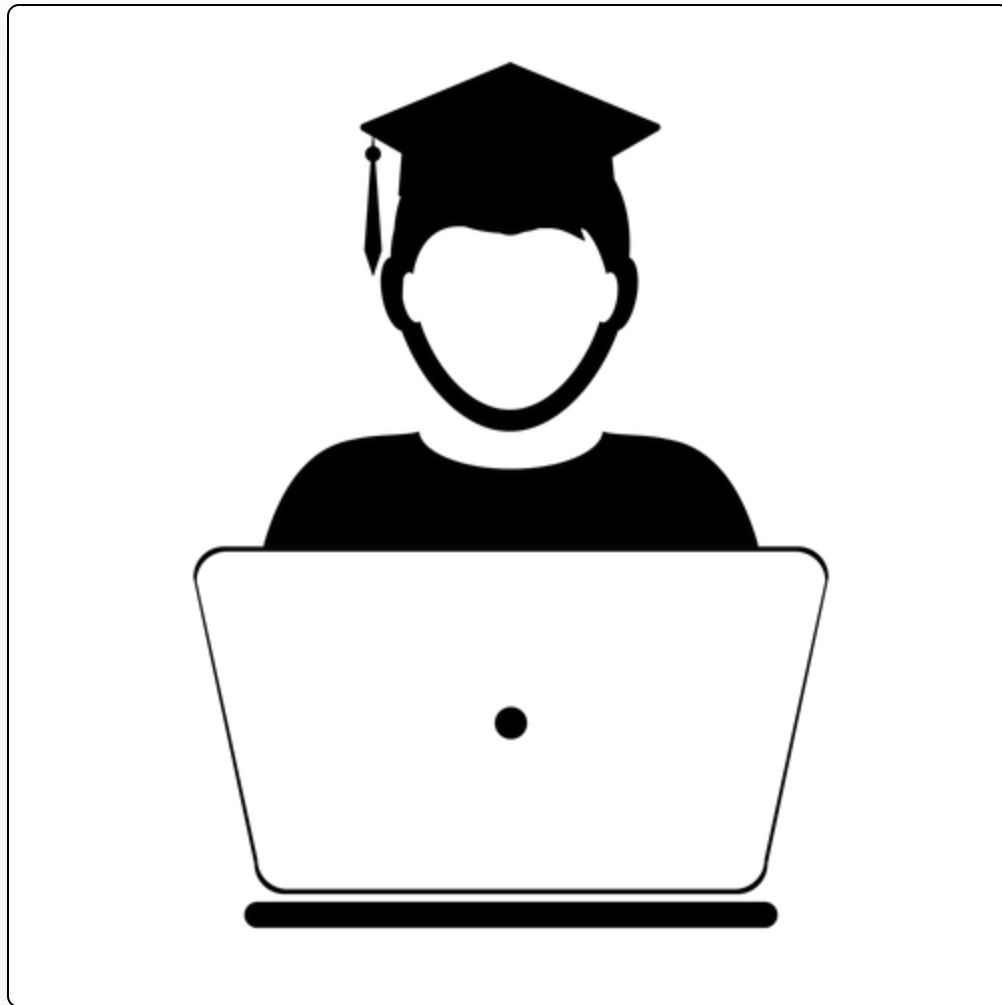


Chapter Three: Political Critique and the University in Roberto Bolaño's 2666

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A map, as of the 28th February 2015, of Chapter Three of [the book I am slowly working on](#).

Chapter Three: Political Critique and the University in Roberto Bolaño's 2666

In Chapter 2, C was presented as aesthetic critique

This chapter is on political critique

Form/content dichotomy is false but there are still strengths of focus

Summary of 2666

- Text is metafictional

 - Reference to utopia

 - "great imperfect torrential work"

Bolaño's novel as crypto-didacticism

- Fiction that aims to teach

- University is represented in this novel

- Sharae Deckard notes the book's "didactic set pieces"

- Subjectification process is pedagogical

Queries politics and teaching function of this pedagogy/didacticism

Two parts to chapter:

- Part I: didacticism/pornography/commitment

- Part II: representation of the university/strategies of condescension

Crypto-Didacticism, Utopia and 2666

- Crypto-didacticism

 - Subform of encyclopaedic novel

 - Moral purpose amid overloaded structure

 - Readers tend to reject this through collective denial

 - They are privileged enough to understand text

 - Bourdieu

- Pynchon as potential generic precursor of crypto-didacticism

 - Gravity's Rainbow: contemporary tech predicated on genocide

 - 2666: 400 women raped and murdered

 - Most criticism takes this as ethical core

 - Farred

 - Boxall

- Readings of ethics in complex fictions imply didacticism

- 2666 encodes didacticism amid overloading

 - Reader must invest intellectual capital to understand

 - Type of reader-active approach of university English

 - Text also encodes jibes at this approach

- Literary studies works against this approach

 - Arriving at endpoint without "work" undoes pedagogy

 - Utopian and pedagogical function against explication

- Theoretical paradigms for reading politically critical fictions

 - Adorno and commitment

 - Response to Sartre

 - Committed vs. autonomous art

 - Content to be fetish

Or falsely denounce ineradicable connection with
reality

Commitment is unreasonable demand of discipline
Problem of empathy as pornography
Carolyn J. Dean's critique
Bolaño's avoidance

2666 in the utopian tradition

More's text as parodic schooling based on historic England
Fictions of process: unfinished, dislocation and reformulation
Comparison to 1Q84
Dislocation: Santa Theresa/Ciudad Juárez
Mapping of city necropolis
Societal independence of art (or not)
Mirrors '68 and university

Quis custodiet ipsos custodes?: Critiquing the critics and the university in
2666

University in 2666 is twinned with the police
Ideological and repressive state apparatus (Althusser)
Idea of harmless eccentric literary critics is destroyed
Misogynists
Racists
Ethics and hypocrisy linked to central tenet of novel
Therefore, does matter

Why?

Farred's critique of "neoliberalism"
Critique of "excellence" and "competition"

Definition of "neoliberalism"

University as always vocational

University in 2666 divided against itself

Is failure as revolutionary praxis
Is also failure as utopian project
Was never pure

Aesthetic vs. political critique in the novel

2666 pre-compromises formalist readings

Also pre-invalidates sociological approaches

"Ethical" lit crit as strategy of condescension

Critics + Liz Norton

Zadie Smith's On Beauty

Temporal disjunction of the novel's title

Amulet reference

Time fluctuation

Bolaño's novel doesn't teach art, it teaches the academy

In this way, though, it becomes itself utilitarian
Keep writing?